

Tribe Boss Undismayed By Hitless Opener; Mele, Valdivielso Coming

By MAX GREENWALD

"I'm not in the least dismayed by our failure to hit in our opening game.

"There was no reason to believe from our exhibition-game showing that we're going to be that bad at bat," continued Indianapolis Manager Andy Cohen yesterday.

COHEN WAS making his appraisal at Victory Field as the weather situation was being waited out.

It was decided to postpone last night's game with Minneapolis because of "unsettled weather." General Manager Ray Johnston and Cohen "took a chance" in the opener Tuesday night and lost that battle with the elements.

The Millers won that contest, shortened to six innings because of the rain, as the Indians failed to get a hit off Stu Miller.

"Miller is the kind of pitcher that, when he is at his best, can make a young club like Indianapolis look bad," Cohen said.

THE TRIBE believes it may have added some of the power it needs at bat with the signing of Sam Mele. The veteran outfielder and first baseman came to terms with the Indians yesterday, having been a free agent since his unconditional release by Cleveland April 17.

The 34-year-old righthanded batting Mele started his baseball career in the American Association, playing for Louisville in 1946.

He was promoted to the Red Sox in 1947 and has been in the major leagues ever since.

In his big league career, Mele tied two records when he clouted a home run with two on and a triple with the bases loaded in the same inning.

THIS OCCURRED in the fourth inning of a tilt on June 10, 1952. His records were for two extra-base hits in the same frame and six runs driven in.

Mele established a mark for consecutive errorless games by an outfielder, 157, from April 24, 1953, through May 23, 1954. The mark subsequently was broken by Larry Doby, Cleveland, 164.

Boston traded Mele to Washington June 13, 1949. He then went to the White Sox in another deal May 3, 1952, and moved along to Baltimore Feb. 5, 1954.

Mele returned to the Red Sox on waivers July 29, 1954, and was sold to Cincinnati June 23, 1955. Unconditionally released by the Redlegs Jan. 19, 1956, he signed with Cleveland April 8 last year.

Mele was in 57 game last year with Cleveland, hitting .254. His top big-league batting average was .302 for the 1947 Red Sox. He tied for the league lead in doubles in 1951 with 36. Twice he tied

for the league lead in fielding for an outfielder.

MELE IS expected to be here tonight when the Indians open a series with St. Paul. Also expected is the mystery shortstop, Jose Valdivielso, who has been quoted as saying he was reluctant to return to the American Association. That's supposed to be ironed out, now.

Cohen has named Al Papai to pitch against the Apostles tonight.

As far as pitching is concerned, Cohen sees no cause for worry.

He was pleased with the

job turned in Tuesday by Barry Latman, especially with the manner in which the youngster handled himself under pressure.

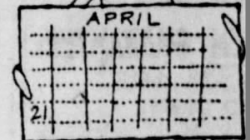
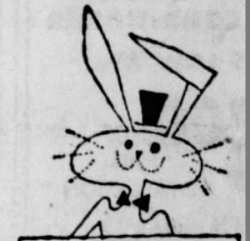
"WITH THE game under his belt, Latman should have more confidence," Cohen said.

St. Paul will be at Victory Field again tomorrow night with children being admitted free.

Omaha comes to the West 16th Street field Saturday and Sunday and Derver will be the opponent Monday and Tuesday to complete the first home stand. There will be a doubleheader, starting at 1:30 p.m., Sunday.



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